# PROJECT LONG COLT

## Player Character Reference Board

Influences: GWOT-era military, Bungie-era Halo 2 Spartan, Republic Commando, Marathon, 90s anime military sci-fi, and hard sci-fi armour. Goal: a bold, chunky, field-maintained armoured soldier who reads instantly in silhouette and holds up in first-person, where forearms, gloves and a wrist display are always on screen.

1. GWOT-Era Real Military (2001-2011)  (5 images)
2. Halo Spartan / MJOLNIR (Bungie-era only)  (5 images)
3. Star Wars: Republic Commando (2005)  (5 images)
4. Marathon (Bungie)  (5 images)
5. 90s Anime Mecha / Military Sci-Fi  (5 images)
6. Hard Sci-Fi Armour  (5 images)
7. Synthesis: proposed palette + design brief

INTERNAL REFERENCE ONLY - copyrighted art (Bungie/Microsoft, LucasArts, Sony, Production I.G, Sunrise, Fox, etc.) - do not ship or redistribute. Halo: Bungie-era only (CE, 2, 3, ODST, Reach); no 343 Industries content. Palette swatches are proposed, not sourced. Full list: sources.md.

# 1. GWOT-Era Real Military (2001-2011)



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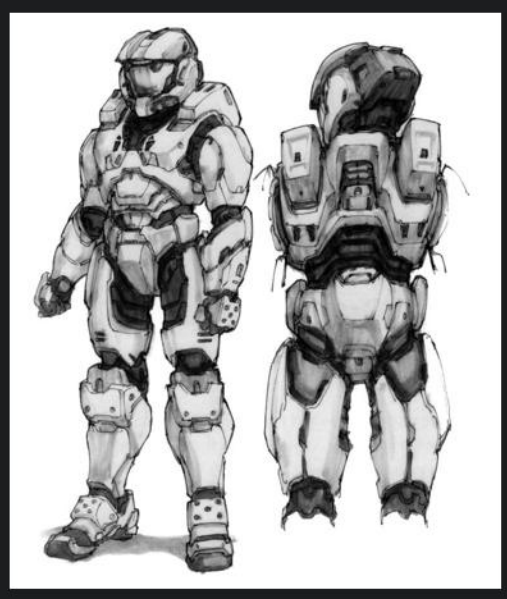
Take the layering: plate carrier/IBA bulk over a fabric uniform, MOLLE pouches stacked asymmetrically, helmet with NVG mount, knee pads, a slung rifle, and the dust, fading and tape of kit lived in for months. Proportions here are the realism floor; the Long Colt suit should read as this soldier, up-armoured, not as a superhero. Note how silhouettes break up from pouches, hoses and antennas rather than from decorative panel lines.


[1] USMC, Fallujah, Nov 2004 - public domain (US DoD) - https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:041126-M-5191K-005_-_Sgt_Aubrey_McDade,_USMC.jpg
[2] USMC 2/1, Fallujah, Apr 2004 - IBA + LWH - public domain (USMC) - https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Zembiec-fallujah.jpg
[3] US Army, Iraq, Jan 2005 - IBA + ACH - public domain (US Army) - https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:U.S._Army_soldiers_climbing_over_locked_gate_in_Iraq,_2005.jpg
[4] 75th Ranger Regt, Iraq, Apr 2007 - NVG at night - public domain (US DoD) - https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:75th_Ranger_Regiment_conducing_operations_in_Iraq,_26_April_2007.jpg
[5] British Army, Afghanistan - full kit rear view - UK MOD, OGL v1.0, Feb 2011 - https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:British_Army_Soldier_in_Full_Kit_in_Afghanistan_MOD_45152577.jpg

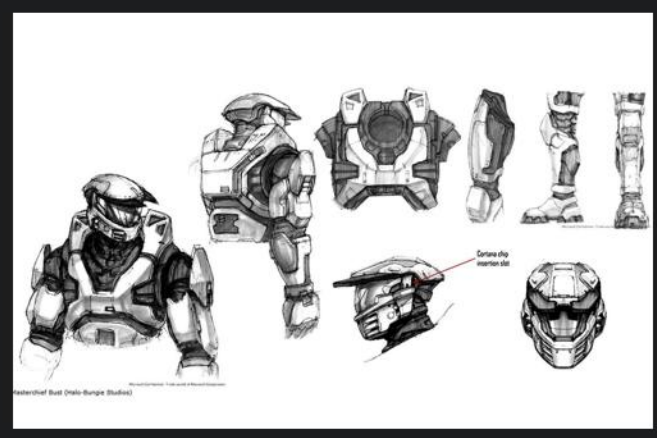


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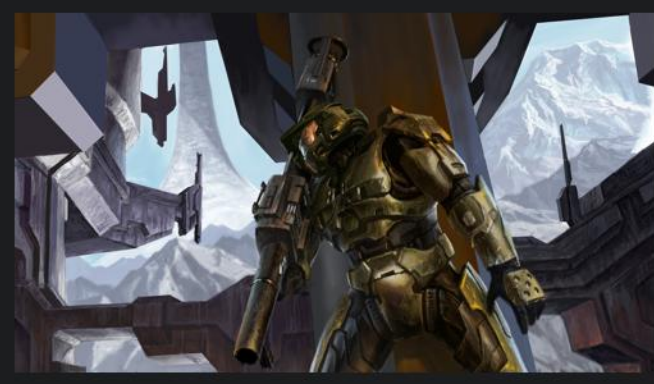
# 2. Halo Spartan / MJOLNIR (Bungie-era only)



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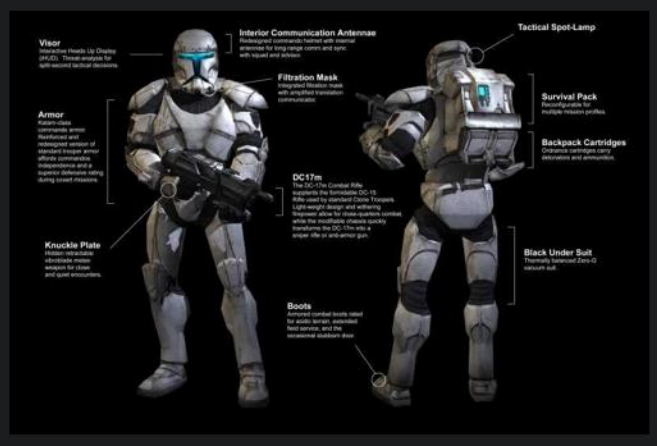
[5]

Take Halo 2's Mark VI logic: a few large, bold armour masses with clear hierarchy (helmet, chest, shoulders, thighs), a dark undersuit visible at the joints, and a single opaque gold-tint visor. ODST and Reach concepts add the field-soldier layer: pouches, knives, webbing and wear over the plates. Bungie-era sources only (CE/2/3/ODST/Reach); every Halopedia file's categories were checked for 343-era content.

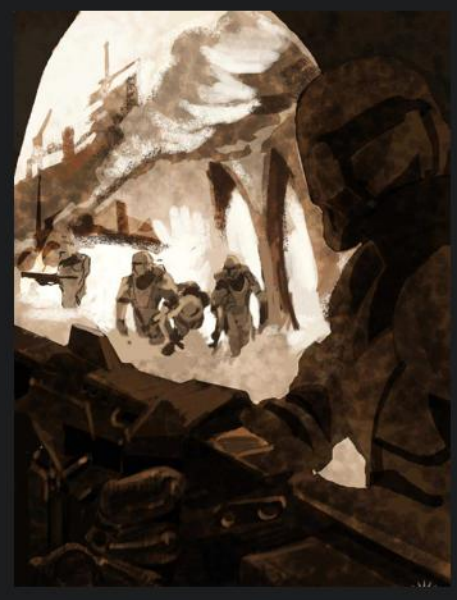
[1] Halo 2 (2004) concept art - Bungie/Microsoft - https://www.halopedia.org/File:H2_Master_Chief_concept_art.jpg
[2] Halo 2 (2004) concept art, Eddie Smith - Bungie/Microsoft - https://www.halopedia.org/File:H2_MarkV_Detail_Concept.jpg
[3] Halo 2 (2004) concept art, Eddie Smith - Bungie/Microsoft - https://www.halopedia.org/File:H2_ConceptArt_MasterChiefTakingCover.png
[4] Halo 3: ODST (2009) concept art, Isaac Hannaford - Bungie/Microsoft - https://www.halopedia.org/File:H3ODST_CQCArmor_Concept.jpg
[5] Halo: Reach (2010) concept art, Isaac Hannaford - Bungie/Microsoft - https://www.halopedia.org/File:HR_Carter-A259_Concept.png

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# 3. Star Wars: Republic Commando (2005)




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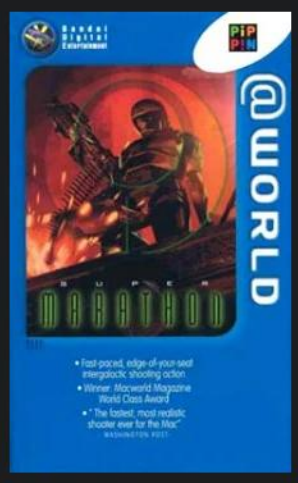
[5]

Take Katarn armour's squad-readable language: colour-coded stripes and stencils per squad member, chunky shoulder/forearm plates, and the T-visor helmet with an integrated HUD that the FPS view is built around. The game's in-helmet visor wipe and visor-edge HUD are directly relevant to a first-person helmet presentation. Avoid the clean white base; Long Colt plates should be olive/grey and dirty.

[1] Star Wars: Republic Commando (2005) - LucasArts/Lucasfilm - https://starwars.fandom.com/wiki/File:Clonecallouts.jpg
[2] Republic Commando (2005) concept/promo art, Greg Knight - LucasArts - https://starwars.fandom.com/wiki/File:CommandosBeingWatched.jpg
[3] Republic Commando (2005) art, James Zhang - LucasArts - https://starwars.fandom.com/wiki/File:CommandoCleanUpOnGeo.jpg
[4] Republic Commando (2005) promotional image - LucasArts - https://starwars.fandom.com/wiki/File:RC-1138.jpg
[5] Republic Commando (2005) cover art - LucasArts - https://starwars.fandom.com/wiki/File:DeltaSquad_RCcover.jpg

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# 4. Marathon (Bungie)



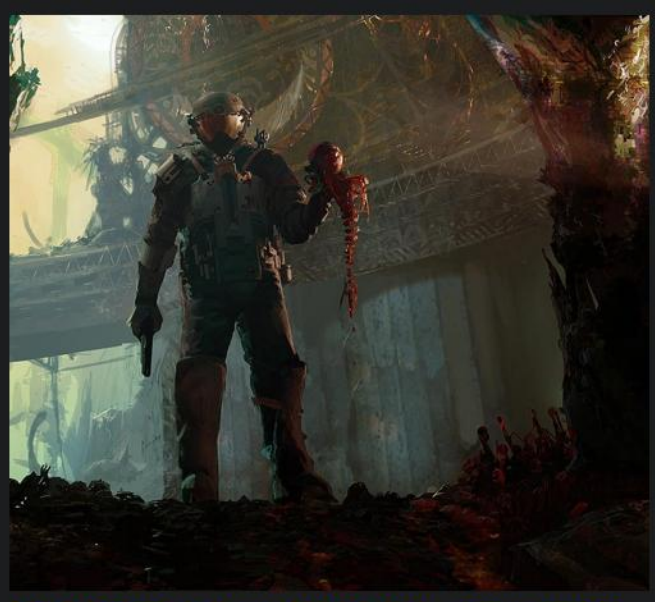

[1] Original trilogy (1994-96)



[2] Original trilogy (1994-96)




[3] Original trilogy (1994-96)



[4] Original trilogy (1994-96) - provenance unverified



[5] LATER REBOOT (2026) - separate sub-group

Take the original trilogy's tone: a lone security officer, utilitarian helmet with an opaque faceplate, bulky industrial armour, and the green-on-black terminal/HUD language that later became Halo. The 1994-96 source art is low-resolution and sparse, so use it for mood and lineage, not for detail. The 2026 reboot image is shown only as a clearly separated contrast: its graphic-design, high-colour look is not the Long Colt direction.

[1] Super Marathon (1996, Bandai Pippin) box art - Bungie/Bandai - https://marathongame.fandom.com/wiki/File:Super_Marathon_box.jpg
[2] Marathon 2: Durandal (1995) screenshot - Bungie - https://marathongame.fandom.com/wiki/File:Marathon_2_multiplayer.jpg
[3] Marathon-era cyborg sprite sheet (game asset rip; wiki gives no source) - Bungie - https://marathongame.fandom.com/wiki/File:Cyborg_Sprite.png
[4] Security officer artwork - wiki caption says 'the game's artwork' but no artist/date/source given: PROVENANCE UNVERIFIED - https://marathongame.fandom.com/wiki/File:Macactionnl3.jpg
[5] Marathon (2026 reboot) promo art - Bungie/Sony (via Game Rant per wiki) - https://marathongame.fandom.com/wiki/File:UESC-runner.jpg

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# 5. 90s Anime Mecha / Military Sci-Fi



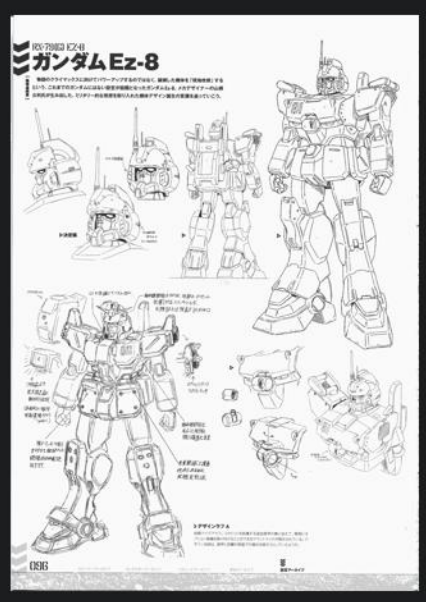
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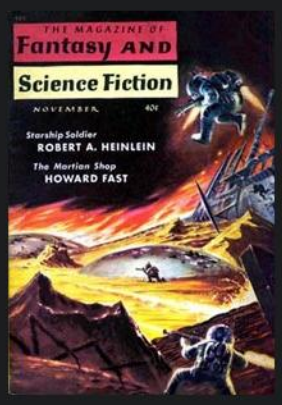

[5]

Take the 90s 'real robot' and Shirow sensibility: hardware that is engineered and serviceable (cross-sections, access panels, hydraulics), squat powered-armour proportions, and tactical gear worn over the body as in GitS 1995. 08th MS Team's Ez8 is the key precedent for field-repaired, jungle-worn machines with mismatched replacement parts. Avoid the spindly heroic proportions and bright primary paint of hero mecha.

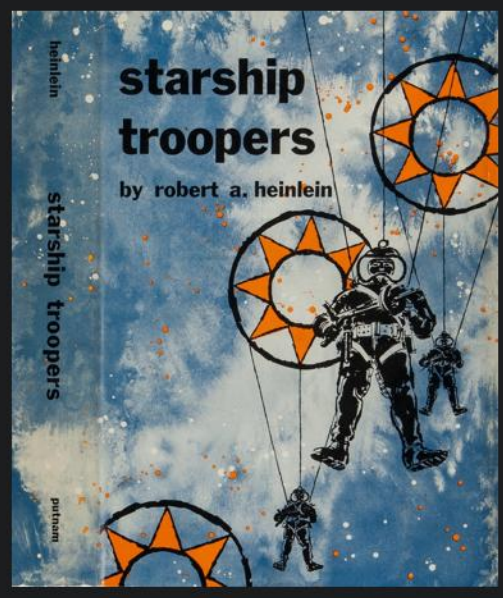
[1] Ghost in the Shell (1995 film) character art - Production I.G/Kodansha - https://ghostintheshell.fandom.com/wiki/File:Motoko-character-art-1995.jpg
[2] Appleseed Landmate cross-section (Masamune Shirow manga-era art; wiki gives no date) - Shirow/Seishinsha - https://appleseed.fandom.com/wiki/File:Landmate_cross_section.jpg
[3] Bubblegum Crisis (1987-91 OVA) hardsuit art - AIC/Artmic (wiki gives no source) - https://bubblegumcrisis.fandom.com/wiki/File:Pre-Knight_Sabers.jpg
[4] Gundam: The 08th MS Team (1996) Ez8 early design sheet - Sunrise - https://gundam.fandom.com/wiki/File:Ez-8_Gundam_Ez8_Early_Design.png
[5] Gundam: The 08th MS Team (1996) design sheet scan - Sunrise - https://gundam.fandom.com/wiki/File:Gundam_08th_MS_Team_RAW_v3_203.jpg

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# 6. Hard Sci-Fi Armour




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Take the plausibility filter: Heinlein's Mobile Infantry as a heavy, ugly powered suit, the Aliens Colonial Marine as an infantryman with practical plate and personalized graffiti, and NASA's AX-5 hard suit for real joint bearings, seals and life-support logic. Every part should have an implied job (seal, bearing, hardpoint, coolant). Avoid sleek film-costume fantasy; the NASA hardware shows how chunky real pressure armour actually is.

[1] 'Starship Soldier' (Heinlein) - F&SF magazine cover, 1959 - non-free - https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/File:StarshipSoldier.jpg
[2] Starship Troopers first edition (Putnam, 1959) cover - non-free - https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Starship_Troopers_(1959)_front_cover,_first_edition.jpg
[3] Aliens (1986) Colonial Marine M3 armor reference - 20th Century Fox (wiki gives no source) - https://avp.fandom.com/wiki/File:M3_Pattern_Personal_Armor.png
[4] Aliens (1986) Cpl. Hicks still - 20th Century Fox - https://avp.fandom.com/wiki/File:Aliens-_Hicks.jpg
[5] NASA Ames AX-5 hard suit (1980s) - public domain (NASA) - https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:NASA_Ames-X5_hard_space_suit.jpg

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# 7. Synthesis: Long Colt Player Character

## Proposed palette (not sourced)

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Field olive / armour plate | #2f3326 | #4a5039 | #6b6f4f | #8e8a63 |
| Undersuit / webbing | #1b1c1e | #2e2f31 | #47463f | #5c584c |
| Worn steel / scuffs | #3d4044 | #6c7075 | #9da1a3 | #c9c6bd |
| Stencils / tape / accents | #d9cfb4 | #c79a3a | #9c3b2a | #e0e0d6 |
| Visor | #1a1408 | #5a4210 | #a87a1e | #e0b04a |

### Silhouette

Bold, chunky, readable at 50 m: big helmet mass, broad shoulder and chest plates, heavy forearms and boots. Silhouette breaks come from functional kit (pouches, antenna, hoses, slung rifle), not ornament.

### Materials

Worn ceramic/steel plates over ballistic fabric and webbing; matte finishes; dark undersuit visible at every joint. Exposed fasteners, straps and buckles.

### Field maintenance

Chipped paint edges, gaffer/100-mph tape repairs, mismatched replacement plates, hand-painted stencils (name, blood type, unit, kill tallies), dust and mud on the lower third.

### Helmet / visor

One-piece opaque visor (gold/amber tint) or a T/rectangular slot; NVG/sensor mount, side rails, chin armour. No glowing eyes, no lit trim.

### Per influence

GWOT: kit layering and wear. Halo 2: armour hierarchy and visor. Republic Commando: squad stencils and in-helmet HUD. Marathon: lone-operator tone, green terminal UI. 90s anime: serviceable engineering, Ez8 field repairs. Hard SF: every part has a job.

### Avoid

Sleek one-piece shells, gloss and chrome, glowing lines, 343-style busy layered paneling and micro-greebles, over-detail that turns to noise at distance, spotless paint.

### First-person view

The player mostly sees forearms, gloves and the rifle: give these the best detail. Gloves with knuckle plates and worn fabric palms; forearm plate with a small wrist display/ammo or comms readout; tape on the wrist; a visor edge or frame option for the HUD, Republic Commando style.

Palette and brief are proposals for Long Colt, not taken from any source.